

ALARM ACKNOWLEDGEMENT — 18–19 NOVEMBER

HOW THIS LOG WORKS

In storm mode every alarm at console 1 must be acknowledged by the operator within **ninety seconds**. Unacknowledged, it escalates to the auto-dialler and wakes somebody at home. Acknowledgement is a physical keypress at the console. **The log is therefore a continuous record of whether a human being is in the chair.**

SUMMARY — 22:00 TO 06:00

Alarms raised	418
Acknowledged within 90 seconds	407
Median acknowledgement time	11 seconds
Escalated unacknowledged	11
Number of separate gaps in which this occurred	ONE

THE GAP

RAISED	ALARM	ACKNOWLEDGED	DELAY
02:38:44	Unit 1 — bearing temp high	03:05:12	26m 28s
02:41:03	Gate 2 — position feedback lag	03:05:16	24m 13s
02:43:57	Forebay — level rate of rise	03:05:19	21m 22s
02:47:12	Trash rack — differential rising	03:05:23	18m 11s
02:49:40	Unit 2 — governor oscillation	03:05:27	15m 47s
02:52:08	Drainage sump 3 — high level	03:05:31	13m 23s
02:54:33	Unit 1 — bearing temp high (repeat)	03:05:35	11m 02s
02:56:50	Crest lighting circuit — trip	03:05:39	8m 49s
02:58:19	Forebay — level rate of rise (repeat)	03:05:43	7m 24s
03:00:47	Gate 2 — position feedback lag (repeat)	03:05:46	4m 59s
03:03:11	Unit 2 — governor oscillation (repeat)	03:05:50	2m 39s

Eleven alarms, all acknowledged in a single burst of thirty-eight seconds beginning at 03:05:12. Eleven keypresses, one after another, at the rate of a person clearing a screen they have just come back to.

There is **no other unacknowledged escalation between 22:00 and 06:00**. Not one. The auto-dialler did not fire on the night; the escalations were cleared before it reached the call-out threshold at thirty minutes.

Operations note: the last acknowledgement before the gap was at **02:37:51**. Nothing was pressed at console 1 for the twenty-seven minutes that followed.

WHERE EVERY CARD WAS FOUND

CREDENTIAL	HOLDER	RECOVERED FROM	TIME
0001	A. SARN	On the deceased, clipped to belt	06:40
0004	H. VEY	On his person	08:05
0007	I. BALLARD	CONTROL ROOM — DESK, SECOND DRAWER	10:22
0022	D. OKONKWO	On her person	08:11
0031	C. MBEKI	On his person	08:09
V-118	P. WRENN	On his person	08:15

Credential 0007, issued to Ines Ballard, was recovered from the second drawer of the control room desk on a lanyard, at 10:22 on 19 November.

It was not on her body. It was not in her locker. It was not in her coat, her vehicle, or the site office.

Her body was recovered at 09:14 from the intake gallery, some 260 metres and two levels from the drawer her card was in.

NOTE BY SCENES OF CRIME

This item was photographed, bagged and scheduled on 19 November. It appears at line 31 of the property schedule attached to the original file. **It was not treated as significant at the time and no enquiry was made of it**, the investigation having by then settled on a sequence of events in which Ms Ballard was alive at 06:02.

Fingerprint examination of the card and lanyard: the surfaces are heavily overlaid and yielded no identifiable marks other than the holder's. Handling by a gloved person would leave nothing. The site issues gloves as standard winter PPE.

THE SPARE CONTROL ROOM KEY

DS The override key you were issued in September.

CM I gave it back on the eighteenth of September. Aurelio signed it in himself. It's two lines in the register and you've got the register.

DS Did you copy it?

CM Did I — no. Where would I copy a restricted-profile key? You need the card from the manufacturer.

Key register entry, return	18 SEP — SIGNED A. SARN
Physical key located	YES — SITE SAFE, TAGGED, UNUSED
Key profile	RESTRICTED — DUPLICATION REQUIRES OWNER CARD
Duplicate requests on file, three years	NONE
Control room door forced or picked	NO — EXAMINED, NO MARKS

The key was returned in September, is in the safe, and has nothing to do with this. The control room was entered and left by credential all night, and that record is already in front of you.

Turnaround: four working days.

WHEN THE DEBRIS ARRIVED

Differential pressure across the intake trash rack is monitored continuously. Debris loading obstructs flow and the differential rises. The trace is a direct record of what is sitting on the rack and when it got there.

TRACE — 19 NOVEMBER

TIME	DIFFERENTIAL (KPA)	INTERPRETATION
02:31	0.4	Gate 2 opens. Racks clear (raked 17 NOV).
02:50	0.5	Nominal.
03:12	0.5	Gate 2 closes. Flow ceases.
04:00	0.5	Static — no flow, no change.
04:12	3.8	STEP CHANGE. Peak inflow overtops into the gallery approach; a debris mat consolidates across panels 3-5.
05:00	4.1	Mat compacting.
07:00	4.1	Static.

COMPOSITION OF THE MAT

Bracken, spruce needles, birch twig, and one length of larch fence rail bearing a **Ravensgate Estate** stamp. The estate reported the loss of approximately eleven metres of boundary fencing from the north shore during the peak of the storm, between 04:00 and 05:00. The material in the mat is that fencing and what came down the hill with it.

The mat formed at 04:12. The deceased was underneath it.

She was against panel 4 before 04:12. Since the only flow into the gallery that night ceased at 03:12, and the racks were raked clear on 17 November, she reached the rack during the single period of flow and nothing has moved her since.

SECOND POST-MORTEM — REPORT

I have reviewed the original protocol, the retained samples, the photographic record and the body, and I concur with Dr Adeyemi in every particular.

QUESTION PUT	ANSWER
Cause of death	Drowning, freshwater. Confirmed.
Alive on entering the water	Yes. Confirmed by diatom distribution.
Injuries sustained before death	None. All trauma is post-mortem, from the rack.
Evidence of being pushed	None, and none would be expected. A push to the back leaves no mark on a body recovered from moving water two days later.
Time of death	I cannot give one, for the reasons the original report sets out at length, and I would decline to give one if pressed in court.

This examination adds nothing to the original. The limitation is not a failure of the first pathologist. It is a property of cold water, and no second opinion will move it. If the sequence of these two deaths is to be established, it must be established by something other than a body.

Turnaround: six weeks. Fee borne by the Review Unit.

ASHGROVE TECHNICAL SERVICES LTD

Registered	2018
Sole director and shareholder	M. VEY (spouse of H. Vey)
Registered office	THE VEY RESIDENTIAL ADDRESS
Employees	NONE
Clients, ever	ONE
That client	THENNICK INSTRUMENTATION LTD

RECEIPTS

INVOICE DATE	NARRATIVE ON THE INVOICE	AMOUNT	CAIRNHOLD CERTIFICATION SIGNED BY H. VEY
2019	"Technical advisory services"	\$61,000	6 days earlier
2021	"Technical advisory services"	\$70,000	9 days earlier
2022	"Technical advisory services"	\$55,000	4 days earlier
TOTAL		\$186,000	

Each payment follows, within nine days, a certification signed by Halloran Vey in favour of the paying company. No work product, correspondence, deliverable, timesheet or meeting record of any kind has been produced by either party in respect of the advisory services invoiced.

POSITION

Household mortgage, redeemed in full	2022, eleven days after the third receipt
Declared to Cairnhold under the conflict-of-interest policy	NEVER
Declared to RDSI	NEVER

CABINET C-14 — WHY THE DRAWING LIED

AS-BUILT SCHEDULE, C-14 — AMENDMENT HISTORY

REV	DATE	CHANGE	REVISER
A	1967	Original issue. C-14 shown DUAL-FED: F-5 (primary), F-3 (standby).	—
B	1994	Busbar rating update. Dual feed unchanged.	—
C	2019	F-3 standby feed REMOVED FROM DRAWING. C-14 shown SINGLE-FED from F-5. Reason given on the revision block: "legacy feeder decommissioned under RG-0419."	H. VEY

Revision C is the drawing held in the control room. It is the drawing an engineer consults before isolating. It is the drawing Aurelio Sarn was working from at 05:52 on 19 November.

RG-0419, SCOPE B — DECOMMISSIONING CERTIFICATE

Certificate title	PERMANENT DECOMMISSIONING — 11 kV FEEDER F-3
Declares	"ISOLATED, DE-TERMINATED AND PHYSICALLY REMOVED"
Certifying engineer	H. VEY
Goods-receipt countersignature	D. OKONKWO
Date	2019 — SAME DAY AS THE SCOPE A CERTIFICATE

PHYSICAL INSPECTION, 22 NOVEMBER

Feeder F-3 cable, turbine hall to substation	PRESENT AND INTACT
F-3 tie switch	PRESENT, OPERABLE, SCADA-CONTROLLABLE
F-3 termination at C-14 busbar	MADE OFF AND LIVE-CAPABLE
Evidence of any decommissioning work, ever	NONE

Feeder F-3 was certified removed, was never removed, and was erased from the drawing by the man who certified it. It stayed live, it stayed switchable from the control room, and it stopped appearing on the diagram that would have warned anybody it was there.

LEG TWO OF THE ORIGINAL FINDING

The original file records that "Ms Ballard and Mr Sarn were overheard at 02:25 in a serious disagreement." One person overheard it. This is that person, asked properly.

DS How did you hear an argument from the downstream powerhouse?

CM Somebody's handheld was keyed. It happens — you put a radio in a coat pocket and it presses against something and the whole net gets your conversation. It came over the powerhouse speaker for about forty seconds.

DS What did you hear?

CM Aurelio, angry. I know Aurelio's voice, he's got that flat way of getting quieter the crosser he gets. And another voice, also angry, and then it cut.

DS Whose was the second voice?

CM I told them Ines.

DS Did you recognise it as Ines?

 [Pause.]

CM No.

DS Then why did you say Ines?

CM Because she'd been on at Aurelio about the piezometers all evening and it was two in the morning and it was a gale and a voice came over the speaker and I thought, they're at it again. Nobody asked me if I recognised it. They asked me who was arguing and I said who I assumed.

DS Could it have been a man's voice?

CM Through a keyed handheld, in a storm, over a speaker in a machine hall? It could have been anybody. That's the honest answer and I should have given it the first time.

RADIO NET RECORDING

Recording retained	YES — 02:24:51 to 02:25:33
Voice A	IDENTIFIED — A. SARN
Voice B	NOT IDENTIFIABLE. Speech-comparison examination inconclusive as to identity and as to sex.
Intelligible content	"...never went in..." / "...first light..." / remainder unintelligible

Leg two of the original finding is an assumption made by a frightened twenty-six-year-old at two in the morning, recorded as an identification. Somebody argued with Aurelio Sarn at 02:25. The file cannot say who.

P. WRENN — THREE RECORDS

No single record accounts for this man's night. Three do.

(I) CONTROL ROOM DOOR

Entry	01:50:12
Exit	01:58:40
Any further entry before 07:00	NONE

He was not in the room the card was in, at any point after 01:58.

(II) RDSI INSTRUMENT VAN — DATALOGGER SESSION

TIME	OPERATOR ACTION AT THE VAN TERMINAL
02:20:14	Session opened, logging started, channel set
02:34:02	Manual mark entered – "gate 2 open, logging spill"
02:51:37	Channel gain adjusted
03:06:20	Manual mark entered – "level response nil, query"
03:29:55	Session closed

The van is on the dam crest, 300 m from the forebay parapet along an exposed walkway. Keystrokes at 02:34 and 02:51 bracket the window in which Ms Ballard entered the water.

(III) SATELLITE CALL RECORD

Number called	RDSI DUTY DESK
Connected	05:58:41
Cleared	06:14:09
Duration	15m 28s
Recording retained	YES — HIS VOICE CONTINUOUS THROUGHOUT
Handset location	RDSI VAN, DAM CREST

The F-3 tie was closed at 06:02:14 at console 1. He was on a recorded call from a van on the crest, six minutes' walk away, for the whole of that.

Take any one of these away and Piotr Wrenn is still a suspect. (i) leaves the forebay open. (ii) leaves 06:02 open. (iii) leaves 02:45 open. **Together they close every window in this case, and only together.**

He remains, on the Inspectorate's own account, guilty of accepting a data package he should have verified. That is a matter for a different tribunal.

CONTACT SURFACES — REPORT

EXAMINATION	RESULT
Arc pitting at the point of contact	Present, consistent with 11 kV
Tissue transfer	Present, matches the deceased
Evidence of tampering with the busbar	None
Evidence of a deliberately created fault path	None. The cabinet was in normal condition and did exactly what an energised cabinet does.
Tool marks, foreign metal, added conductor	None

Nothing was done to the cabinet. The cabinet did not need to be tampered with. Something was done to the *supply*, and metallurgy cannot see that. This examination confirms what B-1 and E-6 already told you.

Turnaround: five weeks.

THENNICK INSTRUMENTATION LTD

Status	TRADING
Contract RG-0419, invoiced to Cairnhold	\$1.41 M – PAID IN FULL, 2019
Purchase records for piezometers P-7 to P-12	NONE
Delivery notes to Ravensgate, 2019	CABLE AND JUNCTION BOX ONLY
Instrument manufacturer's serial allocation	NO INSTRUMENTS ALLOCATED TO THIS SITE, EVER
Drilling subcontractor engaged	NONE
Feeder decommissioning subcontractor engaged	NONE

Thennick installed a junction box and some cable, invoiced \$1.41 M for two scopes of work, and did neither of them. The instruments were never bought and no borehole was ever drilled. No electrical contractor was ever engaged to remove feeder F-3.

Directors interviewed under caution decline to comment. The Registry notes that Thennick has held eleven contracts with Cairnhold Power since 2018, all certified by the same Cairnhold engineer. Those contracts are now subject to a separate investigation which is outside the scope of this review.

FOREBAY PARAPET — REPORT

EXAMINATION	RESULT
Fibre recovery, parapet coping	Nil of evidential value
Contact traces, scuffing	Extensive and undatable. This is a working parapet.
Damage to handrail or coping	None
Footwear marks	None retained. The crest was under 30 mm of standing water and 90 km/h wind for eleven hours.
Biological traces	Nil

Storm Bettany washed this scene for eleven hours before anybody looked at it. There was never going to be anything here, and there is nothing. The examination cannot distinguish a fall from a jump from a push, and it cannot say that anybody went over this parapet at all.

Turnaround: three weeks. The Unit notes that this authority was worth considering and was not worth spending. Both of those things are true.

YOU HAVE UPHELD THE ORIGINAL FINDING

You are entitled to. Nineteen days of competent police work reached it and nothing in this review is obliged to overturn anything.

But before you sign it, answer the Inspectorate. They asked one question in writing on the very first page of the Case Board and they have not been answered yet.

THE QUESTION YOU HAVE NOT ANSWERED**How did she get in there?**

Your finding requires Ines Ballard to be alive and standing at a console at 06:02. Her body was recovered from a sealed concrete gallery, seven metres above a dry sill, downstream of a gate that had been shut since 03:12.

Find the document that says what fills that gallery, and when. Then ask whether a woman at a console at 06:02 could be where she was found at 07:25.

If your answer is that she walked in — check whether the inspection hatch can be opened from the inside, and by whom it was dogged shut, and when.

No score is awarded for this finding. –10 points. You have used one of your two. Go back to the table.

YOUR ACCUSATION OF DESSA OKONKWO DOES NOT HOLD

She signed for six instruments she never looked at, and a dam has been running blind for five years partly because of it. She will carry that. It is not this.

WHAT YOUR THEORY HAS TO SURVIVE

She was underground, in a confined space, wearing a monitor that transmits every fifteen seconds and alarms after thirty seconds without motion. **Find out when, and find out for how long.** Then put those two intervals against the two moments that matter in this case — and be sure you know what the second of those moments actually is.

If you are still working from the sequence the original file assumed, you will not be able to do this. Establish the sequence first.

No score is awarded for this accusation. -10 points. You have used one of your two. Go back to the table.

CASE REVIEW UNIT

RECONSIDER — ACCUSATION RETURNED

R/WRENN

OPEN ONLY IF

ACCUSED

YOUR ACCUSATION OF PIOTR WRENN DOES NOT HOLD

He is the most institutionally motivated man on this site. He signed off an array that does not exist, and a finding of homicide at Ravensgate ends his career either way. If you are looking for someone who needed this buried, you have found him.

He also did not do it, and three separate records say so — **which is exactly why no single one of them cleared him and why nobody has bothered to put them together.**

WHAT YOUR THEORY HAS TO SURVIVE

Three windows, three records, and you need all three:

- Where was he while the gate was open?
- Where was he when the tie was closed at 06:02?
- When was he last inside the room the card was in?

Two answers out of three leaves him a suspect. That is not a flaw in the case; it is what a real alibi looks like when a man spends a night moving about a site.

No score is awarded for this accusation. -10 points. You have used one of your two. Go back to the table.

RECONSIDER · WRENN

ACCUSATION RETURNED

YOUR ACCUSATION OF CATO MBEKI DOES NOT HOLD

He was on the other side of a river.

WHAT YOUR THEORY HAS TO SURVIVE

One door. One log. Nine hours. He crossed the footbridge at 21:04 and he crossed back at 06:05, and the only other route was padlocked as part of storm preparation sixteen hours before either death. **Look at the footbridge log again.**

He did get one thing wrong, and it cost this investigation a great deal — but it was a mistake made at two in the morning about a voice on a speaker, and he corrects it the moment anybody asks him properly.

No score is awarded for this accusation. -10 points. You have used one of your two. Go back to the table.

ENVELOPE S - 1

Case Resolution & Final Summary • Ravensgate

Do not open until the Case Resolution Sheet is complete and the finding is written down and signed.

READING IT

One person reads aloud, in order, without skipping ahead. Pause after each step. Let the table check its own sheet as you go.

There are eight steps and a verdict. Score afterwards, not during.

CASE REVIEW UNIT

RAVENSGATE

STEP 1 · TWO DEATHS, AND ONLY ONE OF THEM HAS A CLOCK

Aurelio Sarn died at 06:03 and nobody has ever doubted it. Ines Ballard drowned, and the Medical Examiner told you in capital letters that no pathologist can say when.

Everything the original investigation concluded followed from filling that gap with an assumption. It assumed she died second, **because the credential evidence implied she did** — and then used the sequence to prove the credential evidence. The file says so itself, in the third bullet of A-1, and nobody read it.

Evidence: B-1, B-2, A-1.

STEP 2 · THE WATER IS THE CLOCK

She was found at trash rack panel 4, at elevation 218.4 metres, inside a sealed concrete gallery.

There are three ways into that gallery and two of them were shut. The inspection hatch was dogged from the outside at 16:40 on the eighteenth and not opened until the recovery team opened it at 07:25. The draft tube ran under vacuum all night, outward and downward. The stoplogs were in.

The only route from the forebay to panel 4 is through intake gate 2, while gate 2 is open and flowing.

With the gate shut, the gallery is dry above the sill at 211 metres — and she was seven metres above it.

Intake gate 2 was open **02:31:08 to 03:12:44**. Nothing else, until 08:40.

Ines Ballard entered the water between 02:31 and 03:12, and she has been on that rack ever since.

And if you bought the rack trace, you know it twice over: the debris mat that formed at the 04:12 inflow peak lay **over** her.

Evidence: D-2, D-2A, D-2B, D-1 §2, and SLIP 04.

STEP 3 · A CARD IS NOT A PERSON

Her credential opened cabinet C-14 at 05:47 and closed the F-3 tie at 06:02. She had been dead for about three hours.

Her card was recovered at 10:22 from the second drawer of the control room desk. Not on her body. Not in her locker. In a drawer, 260 metres and two levels from where she was found — and it was on the property schedule the whole time, at line 31, where nobody looked at it because by then everybody knew what had happened.

Standing Order 11.4 says responsibility for a recorded event rests with the holder. That is a rule about discipline. **It was read as a finding of fact, and it is not one.**

Evidence: SLIP 02, C-5A, E-1A.

STEP 4 · WHY A CORRECT ISOLATION KILLED HIM

Aurelio Sarn did everything right.

He isolated feeder F-5, applied his own padlock, hung his tag, and proved the circuit dead with a tester this department has since checked and found accurate. The cabinet was dead when he opened it.

It was fed by a second circuit. **Feeder F-3** — certified permanently decommissioned and physically removed in 2019, under contract RG-0419, and never touched. Still there. Still live. Still switchable from the control room. And **erased from the as-built drawing at revision C in 2019 by the same man who signed the certificate.**

The drawing in the control room — the one an engineer reads before he isolates — showed C-14 as single-fed. It was that drawing that killed him, three and a half years after it was amended.

Evidence: E-6, SLIP 07, E-2A.

STEP 5 · WHO COULD HAVE USED HER CARD

The control room door did not open between 02:29:55 and 05:44:03.

Three hours and fourteen minutes, one door, badge-controlled both ways, fire escape alarmed and silent. Halloran Vey went in at 21:57 and did not come out. Nobody else went in. Her lanyard was in the desk.

And the F-3 tie was not closed from some anonymous terminal. The log says where: **console 1.**

Evidence: E-1, D-1 §1, D-1A.

STEP 6 · THE TWENTY-SIX MINUTES

His alibi was true, and total, and that is why it took a review to break it.

He logged on to console 1 at 21:58 and off at 07:41 — a single unbroken session of nine hours and forty-three minutes, no lock events, no second operator. Every record on the site says Halloran Vey was at his desk.

Except the one that actually checks. Storm-mode alarms escalate after ninety seconds unacknowledged. Across the entire night there is **one** gap:

02:38 to 03:04. Eleven alarms escalate, unanswered.

At **03:05:12**, all eleven are cleared in **thirty-eight seconds** — the rate of a man sitting back down.

Control room to forebay parapet: **four minutes.** There and back with eighteen minutes to spare.

He opened gate 2 at 02:31. He stood up at 02:38. She went into the water at about 02:50 and the gate he had opened carried her inside. He sat down at 03:04, cleared his screen, and shut the gate at 03:12.

A session log records that a session is open. Only the alarms record whether anybody is in the chair.

Evidence: SLIP 01, against his own account at C-1 and the session record at D-1A.

STEP 7 · THE CLEARED

Cato Mbeki crossed the footbridge at 21:04 and back at 06:05. One door, one log, nine hours, and the service tunnel padlocked since the afternoon. (E-1)

Dessa Okonkwo was underground on permits 1144 and 1145, wearing a monitor transmitting every fifteen seconds, unbroken 02:12–03:40 and 05:35–06:25 — which covers both the gate window and the switching. Against the sequence the file assumed, that clears her of nothing. (C-3A)

Piotr Wrenn was out of the control room after 01:58, at the van keyboard at 02:34 and 02:51, and on a recorded satellite call from 05:58 to 06:14. **Three records, three windows, and no two of them are enough.** (SLIP 09)

Ines Ballard was in the water. (D-2A, D-1 §2)

STEP 8 · WHY

\$186,000, through a company registered to his wife, from the only client it ever had.

Contract RG-0419 had two scopes. Install six foundation piezometers. Remove one legacy feeder. Thennick Instrumentation delivered a junction box and some cable, invoiced \$1.41 million, and did neither. Halloran Vey certified both complete, and within nine days of each certification Ashgrove Technical Services invoiced Thennick for advisory work of which no trace has ever been produced.

For five years he generated the readings himself. The dam's actual foundation pore pressures are unknown and have been unknown since 2019, and the station is now under a Section 10 direction while somebody finds out.

At half past one in the morning, in a storm, Ines Ballard noticed that six numbers were not moving with a reservoir that had come up a third of a metre.

Evidence: SLIP 06, SLIP 11, E-2, E-2A.

DOUBLE UNLAWFUL KILLING

HALLORAN VEY

Ines Ballard is exonerated.

WHAT HAPPENED

They went down forty-one steps at ten past two and opened a junction box and there was nothing in it. At twenty-five past, Sarn told him it was going to the regulator at first light — and the young man across the river heard two angry voices over a keyed radio and assumed, because it was two in the morning, that the second one was hers.

At 02:31 he opened a gate. It was a defensible operation and the Inspectorate has confirmed as much; passing water at 126 cumecs before a peak is exactly what the manual says. It was also a route out of the valley that runs through a concrete gallery, and he knew it, because he had spent eleven years watching that station take in everything that floated.

At 02:38 he stood up. She was crossing the crest to the site office for the as-built drawings — the drawings he had amended in 2019 — and he met her on the way.

Then he came back, cleared eleven alarms in thirty-eight seconds, shut the gate, and worked through the rest of the storm. At twenty to six he told a man he had known for a decade that there was an earth fault on F-5, and watched him go and do everything correctly.

He was undone by an alarm system counting to ninety.

SCORE THE FILE, NOT THE GUESS

Award only for what was written on the Resolution Sheet before the final accusation. **Steps ticked S≤3 — established on the Case Board before the end of Session 3 — score double.**

ITEM	BASE	S≤3	SCORED
Finding recorded as double unlawful killing	+5	—	
Correct culprit named — Vey	+10	—	
Step 1 · Both causes of death, cited	+5	+10	
Step 2 · Ballard in the water 02:31–03:12, by the gate argument	+5	+10	
Step 3 · A credential event is not a person, cited	+5	+10	
Step 4 · F-3, undocumented and undecommissioned, cited	+5	+10	
Step 5 · Control room sole occupancy 02:29–05:44, cited	+5	+10	
Step 6 · The 02:38–03:04 acknowledgement gap, cited	+5	+10	
Ines Ballard exonerated with evidence	+10	—	
Mbeki cleared with evidence	+5	—	
Okonkwo cleared with evidence	+5	—	
Wrenn cleared — all three records cited	+5	—	
Motive established	+5	—	
Each wrong accusation	–10	—	
Clean Sweep — six steps, four persons resolved, correct first time	+15	—	
Each unspent authority	+2	—	
TOTAL			

FINDINGS OF THE REVIEW

SCORE	OUTCOME
100+	COMMENDATION. Charged, and the file will survive anything a defence barrister does to it.
75–99	CHARGED. The right man, and enough working to justify it.
50–74	REFERRED. The Crown will take it. Ms Ballard's name is cleared, which was the more urgent thing.
25–49	OPEN VERDICT. The original finding is quashed and nothing replaces it. Better than nothing, and not by much.
<25	THE FINDING STANDS.

IF YOU UPHELD MURDER–SUICIDE

Then the file closes as it closed before, Halloran Vey retires on a full pension, and Ines Ballard remains, on the public record, a woman who killed her manager and drowned herself in a reservoir. Score it honestly and sit with it for a moment. Every step of the original reasoning was sound; it simply began from something nobody had checked.

TWO QUESTIONS WORTH ASKING AFTERWARDS

1. How many Sessions passed before the hydrology file was tabled? That number is the case.
2. Was holding a file better than sharing everything, as in Case 01 — or did it just mean four people waited while one person read? Say so out loud. That answer decides whether this mechanic survives.